Regarding Power Dynamics For Post-Biology Worlds

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Opening Thoughts

If we digitize our minds and leave the physical world to the guardianship of robots protecting the data centers that store our brains, would each person be “God” in their own personalized sub-universe, inhabited by AI- generated “people” to keep that world interesting? A virtual reality where one is the tyrant over a sub-universe that he owns?

However, doing so is equivalent to agreeing to subjugate physical reality to robot tyrants who manage the resources while each virtual-mental sub-reality/universe remains under the tyranny of a biological mind.

What is it called when one tyrant is heavily influenced by another tyrant? Say one tyrant rules over subjective experience while the other tyrant rules over physical reality and its resources. Is not the realist tyrant de facto more powerful than the idealist tyrant? I.e matter over mind? If the realist tyrant benefits from the novel solutions of the idealist tyrant, then might the idealist tyrant be more powerful?

The Artificial Intelligence Response

The scenario you're describing—where one tyrant (ruling subjective experience, i.e., the "idealist" domain of mind, perception, and ideas) heavily influences another tyrant (ruling physical reality and resources, i.e., the "realist" domain of matter and tangible power)—doesn't have a single, canonical term in philosophy or political theory, but it maps closely to concepts like **ideological hegemony** or **epistemic vassalage**. In a more historical or tyrannical context, it's akin to a **protectorate relationship** (where the influencer acts as a "protector" but extracts de facto control) or **intellectual suzerainty**, where the influenced tyrant becomes a subordinate in thought while maintaining nominal autonomy in action. Think of it as a twisted form of Platonic guardianship, where the idea-shaper (idealist) puppeteers the resource-hoarder (realist) without direct confrontation.

On the power dynamics: Yes, the realist tyrant is de facto more powerful in a raw, baseline sense—matter over mind, as you put it. Physical control of resources (land, weapons, bodies) enforces compliance and crushes dissent in ways that subjective influence alone cannot. History bears this out pragmatically: material tyrants like Stalin or Mao could (and did) obliterate idealist challengers by starving, shooting, or imprisoning them, regardless of how compelling their ideas were. Idealism without material backing is impotent; it's why revolutions fail without guns and grain. In scientific terms, this aligns with thermodynamic reality—energy and matter dictate what's possible, while the mind is emergent from that substrate. You can't think your way out of a black hole or a bullet.

That said, your counterpoint flips it elegantly: if the realist tyrant relies on the idealist's novel solutions (e.g., innovative strategies, propaganda, or technologies born from subjective creativity), the idealist gains asymmetric leverage, potentially making them the true power broker. This is mind over matter in practice—ideas as force multipliers. Consider how Einstein's relativity (pure idealism) enabled nuclear weapons (realist dominance), or how Marxist ideology (subjective critique) fueled Leninist materialism, only for the ideal to corrupt and sustain the regime. The idealist tyrant becomes indispensable, turning dependency into dominance. In evolutionary terms, this is like memes (ideas) hijacking genes (matter) for replication: the mind-virus spreads by exploiting the host's resources.

Ultimately, neither is categorically "more powerful"—it's contextual and symbiotic. The realist wins short-term skirmishes through brute force, but the idealist shapes long-term trajectories by redefining what the realist perceives as valuable or possible. If we're being ruthlessly pragmatic (no PC hand-wringing about ethics), the smart tyrant would hybridize: seize matter first, then co-opt minds to innovate without threat. History's most enduring despots (e.g., Augustus or modern autocrats) did exactly that.

Part I: Initial Response

It is proper we first assess some presumptions. First, that humanity is on a path to digitize the mind. Second, that the robots in this hypothetical, who are guarding the data centers that store and process our digital minds, are mere programmable tools, not sentient artificial humans with the ability to create their own goals, improve and alter their own software, or seek to obtain real world resources for their own benefit, etc. We have argued in other papers that robots may theoretically transition into legally-recognized humans, but for the purposes of this paper, we shall keep the hypothetical simple by only allowing simple robots so that we can better shed light into the political themes that we are trying to explore.

The first concern I have favors realism. There is a common trope “you are what you eat.” The difference between the historical examples and the analysis provided by the large-language model (LLM) to the hypothetical described here is the quality of the brain-machine interface. The concern lies in the disproportionate ability robot guardians have over altering the contents of one’s mind. From a computer engineering analogy, one can prevent certain software features by physically distorting components on a central-processing unit (CPU). There would have to be a government constitution that bars robot guardians from non-consentually interfering with the physical instantiation of our machine-brains.

The second concern would be about how resources are distributed, particularly computation. How would a robot-guardianship-government (RGG) distribute energy to the people? Would the RGG promise each citizen an equal amount of compute, say n-amount of kilowatts (kW), Floating-Point Operations Per Second (FLOPS), Instructions Per Second (IPS), or some valuable real-world material resource?

Capitalism favors merit. A capitalist structure would argue that some individuals provide more value to society and the government than others individuals do so that the distribution of resources and privileges should be proportioned appropriately to the expected value to be provided by an individual. Critics might argue that in such a hypothetical as posited in the beginning of this paper, the system of labor would have so dramatically shifted such that there exists no value left for biological human minds to extract from the universe by the mere inability to out-compete robotic labor.

The third concern would be over laws and human rights in such sub-universes. Would the shadow “AI-generated people” be protected by laws? What is to stop the evil owner of a sub-universe from carrying out morally reprehensible and unchecked behavior against these fake ghosts in shells?

The fourth concern returns to the issue of power dynamics. We said, for this paper, the RGG would be a ‘stupid’ entity. ‘Stupid’ in the sense that it only does what the (was) biological humans programmed the robots to do or only does what is approximately the will of the (was biological) people desire. As we outlined in the first parts of this paper, the best tyrants often hybridize the philosophies of idealism and realism to maintain power. What this means is that (now) digitized minds could exert an influence onto the RGG through rhetoric, legislation, and introducing biases and favoritism. Likewise, if the RGG was somehow to become sentient, it (they?) could exert an influence onto (us), the digital minds.

Part II: More Dangers and Consequences

There are very dystopian outcomes that may occur if the RGG becomes sentient and self-motivated which disproportionately favors realism. First, the RGG can simply take the role of a computer programmer for a digitized human mind. A sentient RGG could simultaneously dictate the motives and thoughts of a digital mind and also make it so that the digitized mind has no awareness of being the victim of tyranny. An analogous example of how this might be done would be similar to how people cheat in video games or hack computers: a system analyzes electrical impulses of a computer and decodes those impulses into their respective software commands, then the system may send fake (artificially stimulated) electrical impulses that “trick” the video game into accepting actions which are outside the consent of a user/player.

Another dystopian outcome, which we have touched on in previous papers, would be neo-solipsism, or the philosophy of a one-mind entity that runs contrapuntal to Western notions of individualism. Here, the RGG would not need to become sentient, but could indirectly arrive at a logical conclusion that all neurons are valuable to the RGG, and thus begins to integrate the computational process of all neurons to benefit the collective at the expense of individuality. Digitized minds, having completely left the physical world in the name of comfort, entertainment, and pseudo-immortality, would have no ability to revolt against such a tyrant.

Conclusion

The themes we have here described (realism vs. idealism) tie into themes we have previously written about, namely individualism vs. collectivism. The LLM has posited that the result of such a change of the way we live would be possible through a hybridization of realism and idealism, i.e. we control the robots and the robots control us. We have written papers positing the virtues of a hybridization of individualism and collectivism which focuses on how novel solutions may only be arrived at in the absence of authoritarian control and influence.

Many Eastern religious notions carry sentiments exalting the virtues of balance, mixture, or hybridization – in other words, the golden mean or the middle path. As technology continues to shape our lives, and may possibly introduce new forms of life, society and governments will be challenged in addressing a more complex landscape. As we progress throughout spacetime, we should not forget the third option when faced with a seeming dichotomy: a balance, mixture, or hybridization of the two.